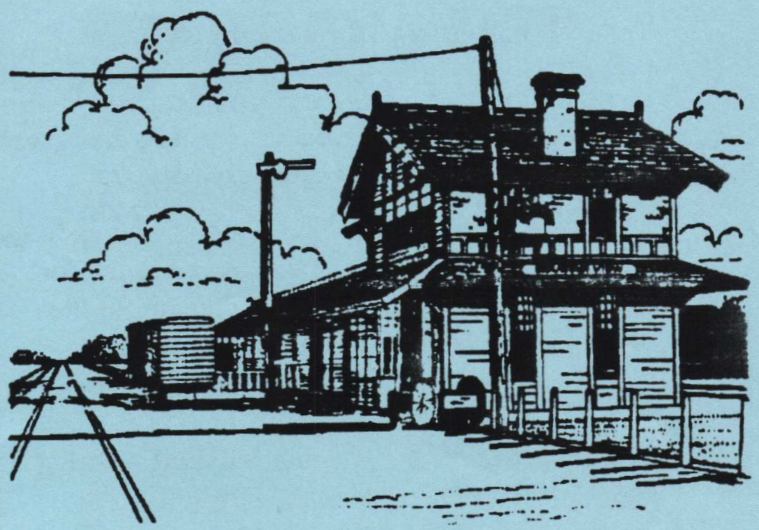
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



AGRICULTURE in the SANTA CLARA VALLEY

The May Meeting

The May meeting will be the first in a series of meetings highlighting the agricultural past of our area. Mountain View Historical Association Vice President Arthur Walton views that agricultural heritage as divided into four eras: the Spanish/Mexican, the post gold rush, the transition to modern, and the era of intense horticulture. The growth and demise of the canneries, box manufacturing, warehousing, water, rail and truck shipping, and family and corporate farming can all be related to this framework.

Santa Clara County was once a major fruit, wine and general agricultural center for the world. The first few years at IBM's San Jose plant the value of the nuts exceeded the value of the computer product shipped.

Art Walton's own and collateral family roots are deep in Santa Clara Valley Agriculture. He will draw on these personal resources as well as the research facilities of the area in bringing us a multi-part overview of what we had and what we have paved over.

SAVE THE ADOBE BUILDING

The February Meeting

The Mountain View Historical Association held its February, 1996 meeting on February 4, 1996 at the Mountain View Senior Center. Arthur Walton, Association Vice President, presented a history of the the Adobe Building and the events leading up to its construction. Art grew up in the area, and was able to draw on his own and family resources to bring the era alive, but he also did his research and brought to his presentation the topical quotes from the journals of the day.

Following his own presentation, Art moderated a panel presentation highlighting the significance of the Adobe Building in the cultural, social, civic and historical aspects of life in Mountain View. A brief report on the present condition of the building and what must be done to restore it to a useful condition was made. The panel presented a number of ideas for possible future uses of the building, and concluded with a plea for community involvement in the effort to save and restore this part of Mountain View's heritage.

*(see - **February** - on page 2)*

THIS AND THAT

ADOBE BUILDING STATIONERY - As part of the effort to "Save The Adobe Building", the Save The Adobe Task Force has arranged for the production of notepaper with a picture of the Adobe. Helen Newfarmer will be selling this attractive notepaper at the May meeting.

REFRESHMENTS - If you are willing to bring cookies or otherwise help with refreshments at the May meeting, please phone Mary Esther Walton at (408)922-0497 and volunteer.

BREWER'S FESTIVAL - Mountain View's annual Brewer's Festival offers an opportunity for organizations like us to earn some money. If you can volunteer a few hours July 12, 13, or 14 to work at the festival, please sign on at the May meeting.

SAVE THE ADOBE FUND - Thanks to all have already contributed. Over $1,000.00 has already arrived. If you would like to contribute to the effort to SAVE THE ADOBE, make your checks payable to:

M.V.H.A. – Adobe and bring it to the May meeting, or

Mail to: *M.V.H.A. – Save the Adobe*
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

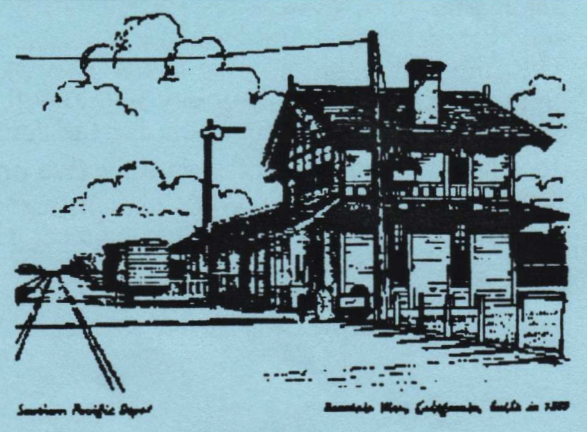
IN MEMORIAM

Lawrence A. Armanini - 93, January 23, 1996, in Sunnyvale. Mr. Armanini was born in Colma, CA in 1903. His family moved to Mountain View when he was three, and he lived in the area his entire life. He graduated from the University of California in San Francisco in 1926, with a degree in Pharmacy. In 1931 he and his brother Albert jointly opened pharmacies in Mountain View and Sunnyvale. Mr Armanini served on the Planning Commission, Personnel Board, and was an active member of the Chamber of Commerce, Italian Catholic Federation, Lions, and the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association. Mr. Armanini is survived by his wife May, four daughters and brothers Albert and August, six grandchildren and four great-grandchildren.

Charlotte S. Puppo - January 17, 1996, in Mountain View. A native of Palo Alto, Mrs. Puppo lived in Santa Clara County since 1947. She is survived by her husband John, her daughter Leslie and her sister Ruth Downing. She was sister-in-law to Christine Faravelli, Louise Pastorino, Irene Garrity, Edward and Robert Puppo and the late Paul Puppo. She is also survived by many nieces and nephews. Her husband John is a member of the Mountain View Historical Association and they are aunt and uncle to Association President Ralph Faravelli.

*(from - **February** - on page 1)*

Panel members were:
Ellis Berns
Hilton Brown
Ralph Faravelli
Peggy Mylrea Matthews
Eva Mockbee
Betty Erichsen Stoddard



MOUNTAIN VIEW WOMEN'S CLUB

By Carol Fischer

A person walking down Castro Street 75 years ago would pass a small, white clapboard building with well maintained grounds and a flag pole in front. This neat, friendly building was the home of the Mountain View Women's Club. A proud, active organization, the Women's Club has been donating its services to the people of our area since its inception in 1904. The Club began with eight members and within six months grew to 23 members. Dues at that time was $1.00 a year. With these initial funds and along with ice cream sales and clam chowder suppers, the club members began their first project— starting Mountain View's first public library. The library reading room opened in 1905 with a total of 88 books and was staffed by Women's Club members.

The Women's Club purchased an old church building in 1919 and had it moved to the Castro Street property. It remained a fixture on Castro Street between California and Mercy Streets until 1965 when the Club was sold due to excessive taxes. Since then, the Women's Club has met in the Masonic Hall on Church Street.

The Women's Club is more than a social organization. Its members work on many local charitable and community improvement projects. Among their works are donations of food and clothing to the Community Services Agency, gifts to the library, and scholarships for local students.

Mountain View has been lucky to have been served so faithfully through the years by the Women's Club. It is important for the community to have the continuity of such an active organization. "Toil is the price of excellence" is the Club's motto— and it is one that our local women have honored these last 92 years!

THE ADOBE BUILDING

By Barbara Kinchen

It was during the Great Depression— thousands were out of work. Bayshore Highway was almost complete from San Francisco to San Jose and the USS Macon was berthed at the dirigible hangar at Moffett Naval Air Station. Farms, ranches, dairies and orchards surrounded the town of Mountain View. The population was 3,308 within town boundaries which stretched from El Camino Real to Washington Street and from Pettis Avenue almost to Calderon Avenue. Most businesses were on Castro Street, clustered in blocks nearest the railroad tracks. At Castro Street and El Camino Real, south of the high school, were the impressive signs spelling out Mountain View in lights. Moffett Boulevard was paved and landscaped within town limits and soon the road would be extended to Moffett's main gate, thus creating a second entrance to Mountain View. At 157 Moffett Boulevard stood the new Junior Chamber of Commerce civic building. The year was 1934.

Members of the Junior Chamber raised money for a Spanish-style adobe building, on property owned by the town, for general community use as well as Chamber headquarters. Plans included a large meeting hall, veranda, heavy wooden beams, fireplace and lighting fixtures with wrought iron details, all under a red tile roof. Workers in government work-welfare programs made the adobe blocks on site and started construction in 1933. Work progressed slowly and lack of funds necessitated a temporary composition roof. Opening ceremonies were finally held in December of 1934. Events over three days and nights included tours, teas, a card party, a banquet, a grand ball and formal presentation to the Town of Mountain View.

La Casa De Monte Vista was chosen winner in a name-the-building contest, but instead it was called the Adobe building or the Adobe and for over 50 years was used for a myriad of activities. There were meetings, parties, dinners, dances, entertainments, classes and exhibits sponsored by

*(see - **Adobe Building** - on page 6)*

SAVE THE ADOBE TASK FORCE MEETINGS

February 27 & March 15

The "SAVE THE ADOBE TASK FORCE" has been meeting regularly. A mission statement has been adopted: ***The mission of the Save The Adobe Task Force is to preserve and restore Mountain View's historic adobe building as a vital community resource.*** Fund raising avenues have been explored and adopted, including solicitation of contributions, participation in civic events, sales of stationery and like items. Organizational matters are being explored— including incorporating as a not-for-profit corporation. A speakers bureau is being organized and presentation material is under development.

The current Task Force Roster:

Wally Erichsen Chairperson

Hilton Brown	Ben DeBolt
Tim Johnson	Eva Mockbee
Trudi Odbert	Bob Schatz
Honor Spitz	Edna Thompson
Kassandra Winder	

In addition, there is an advisory committee made up of persons with special skills or knowledge which may be useful to the Task Force in carrying out its mission. If you would like to get involved in the effort to ***SAVE THE ADOBE,*** contact Wally Erichsen at (415)948-2644 or any member of the committee, or come to the May meeting of the Historical Association.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING

March 6, 1996

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met in the Pioneer Room at City Hall on March 6, 1996. Present were Ralph Faravelli, Wally Erichsen, Art Walton, Eva Mockbee, Edna Thompson, Barbara Kinchen, Hilton Brown, and Mary Esther Walton.

The reports of the Membership Committee and the Treasurer are given elsewhere in this newsletter. A $1,000.00 "seed-money" loan to the Adobe Task Force was approved. Participation in a number of civic events to increase the visibility of the Association and to raise funds was discussed and will be explored.

Copies of the minutes of the meetings of the Executive Committee are available from the Secretary or from the Newsletter Editor.

CONGRATULATIONS!

Roberta Bubb Sweeney and Joseph Sweeney on their sixtieth (that's 60) anniversary!!!



OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS

Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 YEARS AGO (1896): "Mountain View is on the line of the division of the Southern Pacific Coast Railroad (broad gauge) in the most fertile section of the great Santa Clara Valley; it is 39 miles from San Francisco, 11 miles from San Jose, 5 miles from the Stanford University, 3 miles from the bay, 1-1/2 miles from the schooner landing, and within 2 hours ride by rail of the great seaside resorts - Monterey, Santa Cruz and Pacific Grove. The finest camping grounds in the midst of the most delightful mountain scenery in California may be reached by a drive of from 2 to 20 miles from the town, taking in all the renowned scenery of the Santa Cruz Mountains, and other parts of the coast range. Twelve passenger trains pass Mountain View every day, and all but 2 stop here. Two mails arrive from the south, and 2 from the north daily. The climate is mild, its equableness being due to the combined influence of the mountains on the south which are but 4 miles away, and the bay on the north, distant by 3 miles. The chief products of Mountain View are hay, grain, vegetables, berries, fruits, wines and brandies. There are 18 wineries and distilleries at Mountain View and its vicinity, and no section of the State has a more enviable reputation for the products of its orchards and vineyards. A local brickyard and sawmill furnish the chief materials for building at cheap figures. The soil is rich and highly productive, and land may be obtained at a low price in tracts to suit."

75 YEARS AGO (1921): Town Trustees appointed a street sprinkler and cleaner with a salary of $135 a month.

"Don't advertise either your faults or your virtues. Your enemies will attend to former and your friends the latter."

Postmaster Kennedy has received two Smith and Wesson revolvers, with holsters and belts, from Washington. All clerks handling money must be armed while on duty, including Miss Frances Neuroth as she walks up the street to do the banking.

The American Legion meets in the basement of the Baptist Church and the pastor is objecting to one of the popular activities - boxing tournaments.

Domestic science girls prepare lunch for the high school cafeteria. Meals have been satisfying both as to taste and low price for the food offered.

Send sample of hair or color desired for real human hair nets at 65¢ a dozen, postage included.

50 YEARS AGO (1946): Of the 800 registered voters in the Whisman School District, 48 showed up and unanimously voted for school bonds of $56,000 to construct five new classrooms. Presently there are 424 pupils and 13 teachers in the district.

Residents may obtain permits for burning at the Fire House, 140 Franklin Street. No burning is permitted on Mondays.

"NO BELCHES FROM THE BLOOMING BLATTER - With only three small grass fires this week our tender nerves enjoyed the absence of raucous racket from the town fire alarm."

Prices at Safeway: Campbell's Tomato Soup 3 cans 25¢. Lifebuoy Soap 3 bars 20¢.

25 YEARS AGO (1971): Construction was started on the 12-story International Environmental Dynamics building on Castro Street at Mercy. (Now called Mountain Bay Plaza)

Arthur C. Nielsen, Chief of Police since 1952, announced his retirement and Assistant Chief Robert K. Schatz was immediately appointed as replacement.

*(see - **Old News Items** - on page 6)*

NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM

Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From Patricia Awalt Reyburn - 1917 picture of 1st and 2nd grades at Dana Street School.

From Craig and Margery Holden - 1967 snapshot of Paul and Evva Meeth celebrating their Golden Wedding anniversary. Mr. Meeth had been a teacher in local Adventist schools.

From Joe Diaz - Mountain View Pictorial News for Feb 22, 1962.

From George and Alice Holden - Book Aeronautics & Astronautics An American Chronology of Science And Technology In The Exploration of Space 1915-1960, by Eugene M. Emme, NASA Historian.

From William Okamoto - Reader's Digest, September 1988 containing article by Bob Straub entitled Unforgettable Tom McCall. Straub, a MV High School graduate in 1938 was Treasurer for Oregon beginning in 1964, and followed McCall as Governor of Oregon in 1974.

Also - An information sheet about another 1938 graduate, Keith Edward Canella. After finishing West Point, Canella was killed in 1944 while flying out of England for the Air Corps.

From the Estate of Edla Frederickson Black - Graduation programs: 1929 MV High School, 1946 MV Highway School. 17 pictures of classes and choirs at Highway School in 1930s and 1940s.Mrs. Black was both a classroom teacher and music director at the school.

From Audrey Jarvis Hoke - Pictures: George Sohler Family; Winifred Ware Mayers; Fred Maxwell Jarvis a former Chief of Police in Mountain View, father of Mrs. Hoke; Dana Street School class picture 1930s which included little Audrey Jarvis; Newspaper obituary for Fred Jarvis, 1964, who served as Fire Chief in Capitola after moving from Mountain View.

Also in Pioneer Room - 20 minute video by Larry Leib about the closing and razing of Mountain View High School and ceremonies at Eagle Park.

Also - Boxes of stationery with excellent sketch of Adobe Building. Proceeds to go to the Save the Adobe Task Force.

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*(from - **Old News Items** - on page 5)*

Library workers took two weeks off without pay to cover an "under-allocation in their department budget."

The 63-year-old Seventh Day Adventist Church, Bailey Avenue at Dana, was destroyed by a fire caused by a malfunctioning gas heater.

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*(from - **Adobe Building** - on page 3)*

a variety of civic, social, religious and fraternal groups. The Adobe was a Servicemen's Club during WWII years and a game room was added. It was a teen center on Saturday nights beginning in 1944. Classes for children and adults were offered by Mountain View Recreation Department, which moved its office there in 1958 and enclosed the veranda. Long-time users were the American Legion, the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association and the Nutrition Program for Seniors, all displaced when the Adobe was closed in 1987 because of structural problems.

What fate awaits this unique and historic building?

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of April 1, 1996

Reported by Edna Thompson

Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and the names of new members.

Life Members	39
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual Members	109
New 5, Trans. or Disc. 11	
Family Memberships	48
New 1, Trans. or Disc. 3	
Total Memberships	199
Total Members	247

New Members (Since the last Newsletter)

Mario Ambra
Stan Anderson
Michael Bucini
Evelyn Horn (Mrs. George)
Al Miller

Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1996)

Mario Ambra*
Lorena Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Ruth Erichsen*
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Charles Hirschbek*
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard*
Kenneth Richard Malovos*
Madeline Chargin Malovos*
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada*
John Viscovich
Bill Wissell

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President & Program	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Publicity	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

TREASURER'S REPORT

December 1995 - March 1996

As Reported by June de Larios

Balance 1/1/96		$ 5,765.66
Income:		
Membership	$1,429.00	
Adobe fund	1,200.00	
Interest	15.71	
Sales	192.25	
Total		$2,836.96
Expenses:		
Administration	$577.18	
Newsletter	288.37	
Remembrance	26.94	
Adobe fund	130.00	
Total:		$ 922.49
Balance 3/31/96		$7,680.13
Fund Balances 3/31/96		
Adobe Fund	$2,070.00	
Life Member Fund	3,900.00	
Uncommitted General	1,710.13	
Total Funds		$7,680.13

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Regular Meeting

Sunday, May 5, 1996 - 2:00 PM

Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speakers

Agriculture in the Santa Clara Valley

A Presentation

by

Arthur Walton

What? ***Why?*** ***When?***
Who? ***How?***

MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

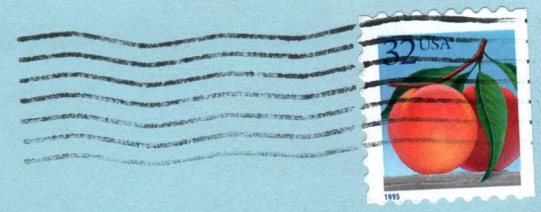
ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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1996



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Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

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